

Smart grill cooking

The Palate Smart Grill lets you grill your food based on weight and composition via your mobile device <http://http://dgit.in/PalateGrill>



NSA-proof chatting

A middle-school dropout has developed a chat program that would be safe from NSA's surveillance systems <http://dgit.in/NSAProofChat>

Hybrid Laptops



The Lenovo Flex 2's screen can tilt upto this angle only. Hybrid enough?

allows the device to seamlessly transition between traditional and pseudo-tablet modes. The device isn't all about the hinge though. It's very well-designed and even without the hinge, is a very capable and feature-rich device that'll give any Ultrabook a run for its money with its support for motion control and hardware volume and factory reset keys. You only get one USB 3.0 port though, which.

Lenovo's always been known to make great laptops and the Yoga 2 is no exception. The hinge is already a Yoga series' trademark and we do love it, but even ignoring it, the Yoga 2 is still quite a beast. The gorgeous screen is one of the first things that hits you when you look at the Yoga. It's about 30% brighter than the rest of the competition and features a great contrast ratio.

Performance figures are a little below average, especially the battery life. Strangely enough, while the maximum temperature hit was only 60°C, the laptop tends to get uncomfortably warm on your lap, which is about the only complaint we have against this device.

Lenovo Ideapad Flex 2

Some call this the poor man's Yoga and we're inclined to agree. You lose out on the Yoga's 360 degree hinge in favour of a 300 degree (approximately) one. In the bargain, you pay ₹10,000 less, get a slightly larger screen and quite a bit more bulk.

The Flex 2 is definitely not a bad device, especially when you also consider the fact that it comes with a dedicated NVIDIA GPU (not a very powerful one). The Flex however, is overshadowed by the Yoga, which, for a slightly higher asking price, offers much more. Why would you buy a Mazda when you can get a Ferrari?

The Flex 2 is, by itself, quite a decent device and one of the most powerful, owing to the dedicated NVIDIA 820M

GPU. Our performance scores bear that out, with the device performing at least 25% better than most of the other devices here in 3DMark. The battery life did take a hit however.

Sadly, the screen on the Flex 2 isn't the greatest we've encountered, dampening an otherwise great device. We were impressed by the speakers, they're loud and severely lacking in bass, but at least don't distort noticeably at higher volumes. Surprisingly, the Flex 2's keyboard actually feels a tiny bit better than the one on the Yoga 2.

Acer Aspire R7

You can't talk about the Acer Aspire R7 without mentioning the hinge (or Ezel as Acer puts it). It's an innovative design that attempts to bring the screen even closer to you and make your computing experience more personal. The flexible hinge allows you to position the display as you like, but essentially you can do three things – bring the screen closer to you while working, make it lie flat for use as a tablet and flip it over to use in 'kiosk' mode. The build quality of this 'laptop' is also great, it has a very premium feel to it and the hinge is far from flimsy. You can position the display any which way and the hinge manages to hold it steady.

Coming to the multimedia capabilities of the device, this

laptop can hold its own with the best. The screen is a gorgeous, 1080p panel that is bright and vibrant and very crisp, easily among the best we've seen on laptops so far. The speakers are another bonus, they're Dolby Digital certified and the audio quality is well above average. Plus, you get four speakers as opposed to the usual two, so you can theoretically take advantage of them to watch movies in surround sound. All this, coupled with a battery life of almost four hours at high load makes this a very capable multimedia device. The problem with this device is that we can't seem to see the point in it. It's not like a standard hinge is inconvenient and even though you can flip the display over, why can't you just flip the laptop around as you always used to?

The repositioned keyboard feels awkward on the R7 and it's quite painful to use on your lap when there is no palm-rest, it's fine on a desk though; the keys don't engender much confidence either and feel a bit floaty. This is, undeniably, an excellent device. The hardware is nice, and if you can find a use for the hinge and can get over the touchpad and keyboard positioning, not to mention the large size of the hybrid device, this machine can be worth the hole that it'll burn in your pocket – and the envy of everyone around you.

Winners

The Acer Aspire R7 is our Best Performer, because of its hardware and large form factor, overall. The HP Pavillion x360 wins the Best Buy Award as it offers a very good combination of looks, design, performance and price. The Lenovo Yoga 2 gets the Editor's Pick Award for being a unique hybrid device with 360-degree screen. 



The Acer Aspire R7 deservedly wins our Best Performer Award